

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Which Country Has The Best Schools?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 20

No.	Sentence
1	The OECD carries out the Pisa tests _____.
2	The tests compare teaching in maths, science and _____.
3	At first, comparing countries through Pisa caused _____.
4	Some critics questioned the _____ of comparing very different countries.
5	A common pattern is that top-performing countries tend to be _____.
6	Large Western European countries are being _____ by faster-rising places.
7	Pisa is defended as a way to measure readiness for a _____.
8	Successful systems help all pupils reach a _____.
9	This should happen regardless of students' _____.
10	Estonia avoids teaching students by separate levels because it does not want to _____ them.

11 **What do the Pisa tests try to measure?**

- A How much schools spend on education
- B How effectively countries teach key school subjects
- C How satisfied students are with teachers
- D How many students enter university

12 **Why were the Pisa rankings controversial when introduced?**

- A They were only available in small countries
- B They ignored maths and science completely
- C They were designed by individual schools
- D People doubted whether very different places could be compared

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **What pattern is mentioned in the rankings?**
- A Smaller countries often appear among the strongest performers
 - B Western Europe always leads the tables
 - C Large countries are excluded from the rankings
 - D Only English-speaking countries perform well
- 14 **How are places such as Singapore, Estonia and Taiwan described in relation to larger European countries?**
- A Too small to be considered rivals
 - B Historically dominant economic powers
 - C Fast-rising competitors that outperform them
 - D Countries with weaker school systems
- 15 **What is meant by a knowledge economy here?**
- A An economy based mainly on farming
 - B An economy relying on highly educated workers in skilled industries
 - C A system where students study only technology
 - D A ranking that measures national income
- 16 **What factor is introduced as helping countries do well in Pisa?**
- A Allowing only top students to take tests
 - B Dividing all pupils by ability from the start
 - C Focusing mostly on private schools
 - D Prioritising getting every pupil to a certain level
- 17 **What does Sean say successful systems do?**
- A They ensure pupils reach a standard whatever their background
 - B They select pupils according to family background
 - C They remove reading from the curriculum
 - D They measure only the strongest students
- 18 **What is Rando Kuustik's view of teaching students by different ability levels?**
- A It is the only way to improve scores
 - B It is useful if done internationally
 - C It separates people in a way schools should avoid
 - D It has no connection with Estonia's success

19 **In the phrase "regardless of their background", what is being treated as not a barrier?**

- A The country's population size
- B Pupils' personal or social background
- C The school's test schedule
- D The language used in the exam

20 **What broader idea does Estonia's example support?**

- A Elite separation is essential for top rankings
- B School success depends only on national wealth
- C Large countries should not take Pisa tests
- D Inclusive education can be linked to strong performance